

Historical documentation

Class timeline and archival-research database

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1 Historical documentation

For each event or primary-source artifact contributed to the class database, document the following information. Complete fields as precisely as possible. When information is uncertain or unavailable, use a brief note such as **Unknown**, **Approximate**, or **Not applicable** rather than leaving the field blank.

Database field	What to enter
record_id	A unique identifier assigned to the entry
event_or_artifact_name	A concise, descriptive title
record_type	Event or Artifact
date_start	Start date or approximate year/date
date_end	End date, where applicable
date_precision	Exact date , Year , Decade , Approximate , or Date range
location	City, state/territory, region, nation, or another relevant location
historical_period	The broader historical period selected by your group
summary	A brief factual description
major_event	1 = yes; 0 = no

Database field	What to enter
major_event_rationale	Explain why the event does or does not meet your group's criteria for a major historical event
education_related	1 = yes; 0 = no
education_connection	Explain the item's relevance to schools, teaching, learning, literacy, educational access, or policy; enter N/A when not applicable
primary_source_title	Title or description of the primary source
primary_source_creator	Person, organization, court, newspaper, institution, or other creator
primary_source_date	Date the primary source was created or published
repository	Archive, collection, library, or database where the source was found
source_url	Stable public URL or repository permalink
citation	Full citation in APA, MLA, or Chicago style
trial_connection	Plessy, Brown, Both, or No direct connection
trial_connection_note	Explain any connection to historical context, legal questions, educational access, or group research
group_id	Your timeline group identifier
contributors	Names of the students responsible for the entry
verification_status	Draft, Reviewed by group, or Ready for class database

2 Classification codebook

Use the following codes consistently so that the class can filter, sort, and visualize the shared database.

Field	Code	Meaning
major_event	1	The event meets the group's stated criteria for historical significance

Field	Code	Meaning
major_event	0	The event does not meet the group's stated criteria for historical significance
education_related	1	The event or artifact directly relates to schools, teaching, learning, literacy, educational access, or education policy
education_related	0	The event or artifact does not directly relate to education

3 Documentation reminder

An entry can be historically significant without being directly related to education. Likewise, an artifact can be directly related to schooling or teaching without being classified as a major event.

For example, *Brown v. Board of Education* can be coded as both a major event (1) and education related (1). A local school-board record may be coded as not a major event (0) but education related (1).

Return to the [historical artifacts page](#) for the full timeline activity, archive resources, group roles, and the connection between historical research and the Supreme Court trial reenactments.